

Literary Analysis of The Hobbit

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Imagine a world where comfort and adventure coexist, controlled by our inner desire. In *The Hobbit*, every character can be viewed through a psychoanalytic lens, showing their true intentions through unconscious motivations, fears, or inner conflicts. The Tooks are known for being adventurous, while the Baggins are known for the joy of comfort. Through a psychoanalytic lens, *The Hobbit* suggests that Bilbo's courage arises from unconscious fears as he progresses through the adventure, embracing his true identity as a Baggin and Took.

The idea of the Baggins heavily influences Bilbo through regret. Gandalf pressures Bilbo to go with Thorin and company on an adventure to take the wealth of Smaug, the dragon. (Tolkien, 1937, p. 29) Bilbo was considered the ideal burglar by Gandalf; however, part of Bilbo did not want to take on this task. Since the Baggins are known for never leaving their Hobbit hole, this scene reveals an unconscious fear of abandoning the comfort Bilbo cherishes. Later on, Bilbo and the dwarves were captured by the goblins, and Bilbo was forced to act on his own. (Tolkien, 1937, p. 63) Bilbo was placed in the goblin's cave, where this scene symbolizes regret as things become frightening and dark. This shows Bilbo's unconscious fear of abandoning comfort to pursue adventure. According to Ben Cohen, Bilbo has to transition from his Baggins life to enduring several unfamiliar environments, whether facing harsh weather, rough sleeping conditions, or encountering enemies. (Cohen, 2023)

As Bilbo pursues his Took side, his courage emerges through ego as he is forced to learn to persevere through his unconscious fears. Bilbo faces his internal tensions head-on, symbolized by his fight with the spiders. "The spider lay dead beside him, and his sword-blade was stained

black. Somehow the killing of the giant spider, all alone by himself in the dark without the help of the wizard or the dwarves...” (Tolkien 1937, p. 137) By killing the spider, Bilbo found the ego needed to control his unconscious fears, giving him the courage to overcome obstacles on the journey. This shows the rise of courage as Bilbo becomes more aware of his perseverance, accepting his identity as a Baggin and Took. According to P Brandt, Bilbo killing the spider without the help of Gandalf and the others represents self-confidence through fierceness and boldness. (Brandt, 2018)

Although Bilbo’s courage is unconscious, this can be viewed differently through moral conviction. Tolkien portrays Bilbo as a moral hero because he shows how a character’s decisions reveal their values and the theme of the story. (Schreiner, 2018) Near the end of the story, Bilbo gives the Arkenstone to Bard to prevent a war, choosing peace over wealth and the loyalty of the group. This act shows that Bilbo’s courage is a moral conviction, as he is brave enough to lead himself and others in what he believes is right. However, Tolkien’s narrative techniques enforce Bilbo’s courage by overcoming unconscious fears. Through a third-person perspective, it constantly portrays the doubts and fears that drive his decisions to act. While Bilbo’s decision to give away the Arkenstone can be seen as a moral conviction, Bilbo’s courage emerged from his unconscious fears rather than morality. Throughout *The Hobbit*, Bilbo is constantly affected by his unconscious fears, pressuring his true intentions. His decision with the Arkenstone was more than morality; it was a worry about an uncontrollable situation involving his friends due to the greed for wealth.

In a psychoanalytic lens, the unconscious fears Bilbo encounters throughout the journey emerge into courage, allowing him to embrace two identities as a Baggin and a Took. Through this lens, it reveals a deeper pattern of fear, developing courage to overcome obstacles, whether it is internal or external. Bilbo's adventure in *The Hobbit* reflects to us in the real world how internal conflicts shape our choices in the real world, as we all act under unconscious pressure

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